



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Candies Creek Academy
School Website: <https://candiescreekacademy.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Austin Classical School — Classicality Audit

School website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: The school publicly centers its mission on "glorify[ing] Jesus Christ," partners "with families to cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students," and explicitly frames learning around truth, goodness, and beauty using the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, great books, debate/discussion, and thesis defense—strong alignment with the "Six Essential Elements" positive indicators and lexicon for classical schools .

- Highlights:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit (Christ-centered, Bible, theology; TGB language) .
 - Purpose centers on formation in wisdom and virtue (not college/career prep), with "eternal purpose" emphasis .
 - Curriculum reflects the Trivium, Latin, great books, and Western tradition .
 - Pedagogy includes memory work, chanting/songs, debate/discussion, and rhetoric/thesis defense .
 - Parents & community partnership is structurally central (collaborative "co-teacher parent" model, office hours, tours) .
 - Faculty evidence is strong but less explicit than other areas; language about teachers "helping form the souls of our children" and ACCS accreditation still indicate alignment .
- Method: The audit follows the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" keyword indicators (positive/negative) and the classicality lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty; Trivium; Socratic/debate; chanting; etc.) to quantify hits and coverage before scoring each category .

Note: "Positive" and "Negative" terms below are taken from the Six Essential Elements indicators and the lexicon; presence/absence and frequency inform the category scores, per instructions .

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations 1) School keywords observed - "Glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"; "wise, virtuous, humble"; "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty"; "Bible"; "theology"; "the sovereignty of God" . 2) Match to Six Elements (Positive/Negative) - Positive matches: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology/Bible; Christian worldview; Logos/God language (Religious & Metaphysical foundations, positive list) .

- Liturgical/communal worship is not explicitly described (chapel, morning prayer not found in crawl excerpts).
 - Negative indicators (values□neutral, secular humanism, relativism) not present .
- 3) Quantitative estimate
- Positive keyword hits: +10 (e.g., Christ/Christian, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, Bible, theology, God, sovereignty)
 - Negative keyword hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage (of sub-criteria): ~67% (2 of 3: moral realism/TGB; grounded in theology; liturgy not evidenced)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Strong theological grounding and TGB language meet core metaphysical criteria, even without explicit chapel/liturgy evidence.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal 1) School keywords observed - “cultivate wisdom and virtue”; “eternal purpose”; “great conversation”; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation ... not ... a traditional college preparatory institution ... our goal is not to prepare students for college but for life” . 2) Match to Six Elements - Positive matches: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information; classical mission (great conversation) .

- Negative (college/career readiness, 21st-century skills emphasis) absent; ACS explicitly rejects such an aim . 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: +10

- Negative: -0

- Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage: 100% (all listed elements appear) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum 1) School keywords observed - “Trivium ... Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric”; “Latin (5th–8th) ... formal logic ... rhetoric instruction”; “great ideas ... great books ... Western tradition”; “Bible”; “history” (not “social studies”); “art and music” . 2) Match to Six Elements - Positive matches: Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis; great books and primary texts; Latin; history; integrated knowledge under theology/God (curriculum content and structure) .

- “Wonder” language is implied (curiosity/passion) but “wonder” not explicitly named in the crawl excerpts.

- Negative (STEM-first framing; “social studies” replacing history; project-based dominance) not present; ACS bans most devices on campus, reinforcing classical approach . 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: +12

- Negative: -0

- Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage: ~75% (Trivium, great books, history clear; “wonder” explicit phrasing not found) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods 1) School keywords observed - Grammar (K–4): “memorization, recitation, and songs”

- Logic (5–8): “debate and discussion”

- Rhetoric: “thesis defense ... eloquent written and oral communication”

- Memory training emphasized; “pre-Progressive ... trust the tried and true” . 2) Match to Six Elements - Positive matches: chanting/singing/memorization; debate/discussion (Socratic/dialectic equivalents); rhetoric (speeches/thesis). “Scholé/restful learning” and explicit “Socratic” term are not stated in the excerpts, but debate/discussion and thesis defense fulfill the classical dialectic/rhetoric aims .

- Negative (project-based/experiential emphasis, student-directed constructivism) not present . 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: +9

- Negative: -0

- Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage: ~60% (3 of 5: memory/chanting, dialectic discussion/debate, rhetoric/orations; no explicit “scholé” language; “wonder” pedagogically implied but not stated) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Clear alignment with trivium-stage pedagogies; upper-school rhetoric and debate are explicit.

Element 5: School Faculty 1) School keywords observed - “Faculty ... who love Jesus ... talented and dedicated teachers ... using the classical approach”; “These Jesus-loving men and women are helping form the souls of our children ... what’s modeled ... how they’re loved ... disciplined ... shown grace” .

- ACCS accreditation (2025) indicates faculty/leadership alignment with classical formation standards . 2) Match to Six Elements - Positive matches: teachers as moral exemplars/mentors; formation of affections; wisdom-centered teaching (Faculty positive indicators) .

- “Portrait of a Teacher” / “faculty of friends” phrasing not explicit in the crawl. - Negative (teacher as mere facilitator; certification-jargon) not present . 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: +5

- Negative: -0

- Percent positive: 100%

- Coverage: ~50% (evidence of exemplar/mentorship clear; less explicit on collegial “faculty of friends”/formal teacher portrait) 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Strong formation language and accreditation are positives; a few classical faculty hallmarks are less explicit in public materials.

Element 6: School Parents and Community 1) School keywords observed - “co-laboring with families”; “collaborative schedule ... co-teacher parent”; weekly lesson plans to parents; teachers’ office hours on homeschool days; information meetings/tours; “partner with your family” invitations; family-time emphasis and parent involvement baked into the model . 2) Match to Six Elements - Positive matches: parental primacy/partnership; parent formation aids (recommended readings; meetings/tours); open, hospitable community structures (partnership with families) . - Negative (parent as customer only/minimal involvement) not present. 3) Quantitative estimate - Positive: +10
- Negative: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 100% (all partnership elements evidenced) 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Classification - Category ratings:

- Religious & Metaphysical: CLASSICAL (100% pos; 67% coverage; +10/-0)
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL (100%; 100%; +10/-0)
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL (100%; 75%; +12/-0)
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL (100%; 60%; +9/-0)
- Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (100%; 50%; +5/-0)
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL (100%; 100%; +10/-0) - Overall: CLASSICAL
- Justification: Five out of six categories are clearly classical with abundant positive hits and zero negatives. Faculty language is strong but somewhat less explicit on a few classical hallmarks, which slightly lowers that single category.

Key Evidences Cited from School Site - Mission: “glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students ... classical, Christian education” .

- Classical basics: TGB aim/method; Trivium stages; memory/recitation/songs; debate/discussion; rhetoric and thesis defense; Latin; logic/rhetoric sequence .
- Educational approach: pre-Progressive; Bible; great works of Western tradition; Latin; art/music; reason and order; memory training; critique of technology dependence (with low-tech campus norm) .
- Parent partnership: collaborative model; co-teacher parent; teacher office hours; tours/information meetings .
- Faculty: “Jesus-loving ... form the souls of our children” + ACCS accreditation (2025) .

Note on Keyword Framework - Positive/negative indicators and lexicon applied per “Six Essential Elements” guidance (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom; trivium/quadrivium; great books; chanting/memorization; debate/dialectic; parent partnership) .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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